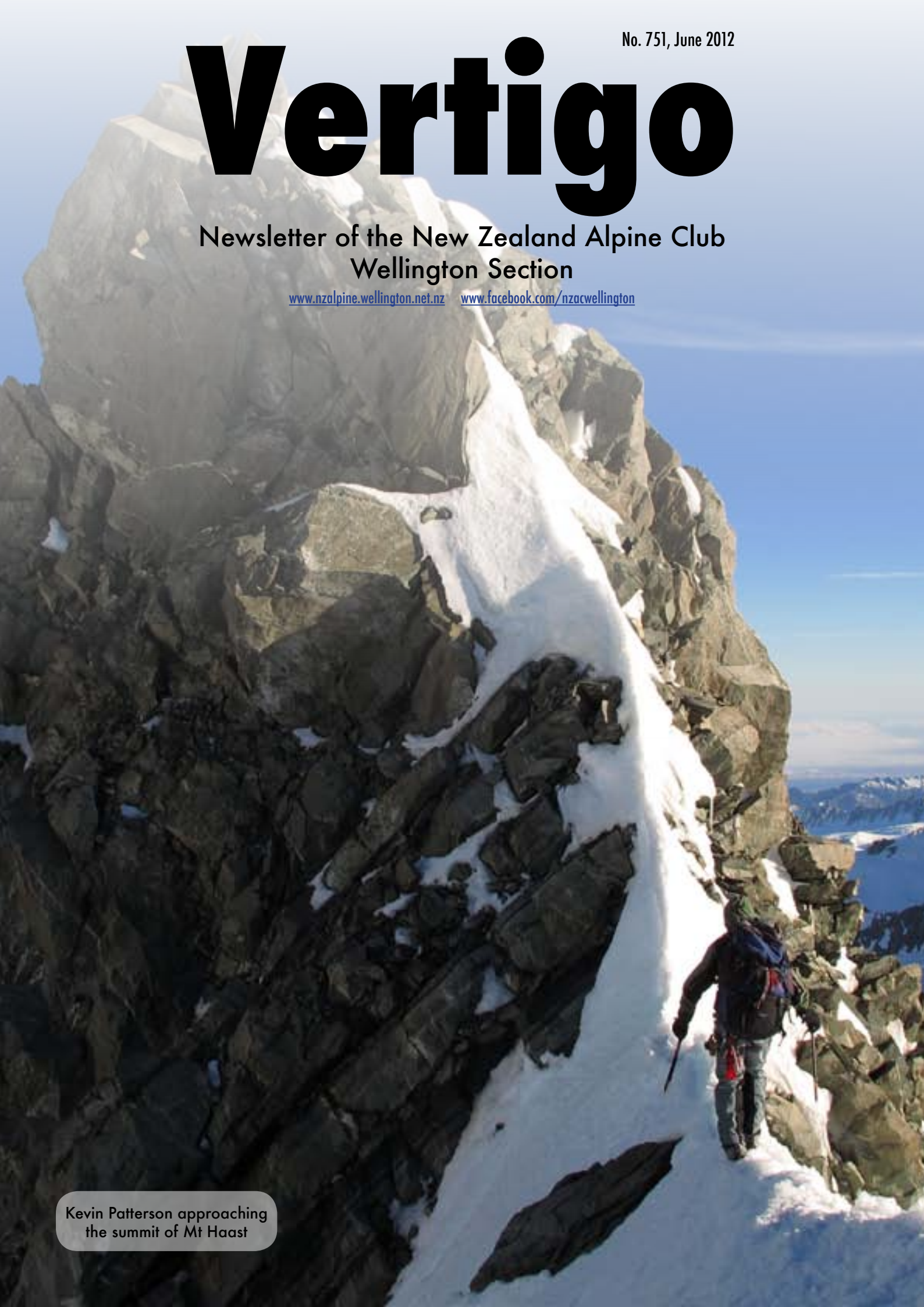


No. 751, June 2012

Vertigo

Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club
Wellington Section

www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz www.facebook.com/nzacwellington



Kevin Patterson approaching
the summit of Mt Haast

Next section night: 11 June, 2012

Photo Comp!



Come and see the best of 2011/12 photos on show on the big screen – pictured here are some of the 2011 competition winners.

Clockwise from top left: Flock Air by John Palmer, Sawcut Gorge, Seaward Kaikouras by Andy Maloney, Into the White by Stefanie Pontasch, and Sunrise by Lauren Schaer.



Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



THE WORLD'S BEST MOUNTAIN FILMS

THE BANFF CENTRE PRESENTS
2011 / 2012

BANFF MOUNTAIN FILM FESTIVAL WORLD TOUR

Tuesday 12 June and
Tuesday 19 June 6.30 pm
Paramount Cinema,
25 Courtenay Place

Tickets:
\$18 NZAC members and students ■ \$20 non-members
Available from the Paramount Cinema, ph 04 384 4080,
and through their online booking system

www.banffmountainfestival.ca



The Banff Centre
inspiring creativity

WELLINGTON



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB



WORLD
expeditions



Adventure
South

Banff Mountain Film Festival 2012

All bookings can be made through the Paramount: in person at the cinema, by phone (04 384 4080), or through their online booking system. Tickets are \$18 for NZAC members and students, \$20 for non-members.

Night 1 (12th June)

[ALL.I.CAN](#): THE SHORT CUT

Best Feature-length Mountain Film. Stunning time-lapse sequences, creative visuals, great skiers, and deep powder are highlights of this excerpt from the award-winning feature film that looks at snow sports and the environment.

GRAND LIBRE AU GRAND CAP

Join Arnaud Petit and Stéphanie Bodet as they attempt what might be the toughest route in the Alps, a majestic 3,900-metre pinnacle that juts from the Mont Blanc Massif: Grand Capucin. Close camera work and lively discussion along the route allow us intimate access to a refreshing and effective climbing partnership. French with English subtitles.

NARSICAME

Everything you ever wanted to know about 'Strap Induced Digitally Compressed Strapped Syndrome'

HANUMAN AIRLINES

Two Nepali adventurers channel the Hindu God of Wind on their mission to launch a paraglider from Mount Everest's summit and travel to an ocean they have never seen.

WHITEWATER GRAND PRIX

Twenty-eight of the world's most talented and progressive kayakers compete in a multi-disciplined competition on spectacular whitewater across Quebec.

REEL ROCK: ICE REVOLUTION

A revolution is taking place, led by Canadian maniac Will Gadd. After 30 years of ice climbing, Gadd has finally realized his dream of climbing radically overhanging, heinously difficult ice at British Columbia's spectacular Helmcken Falls. Gadd and Tim Emmett dodge exploding icicle bombs and send the hardest pure ice climb in the world.

SOLITAIRE

In the high desert of South America, winter takes hold, and a handful of drifters emerge from the whiteout, ready to cast their lot onto inhospitable lands and forsaken peaks. Joseph Conrad's Heart of Darkness is the inspiration for a poetic and visually stunning film that ventures beyond the frontiers of most mountain sports films.

REEL ROCK: ORIGINS — OBE & ASHIMA

There's a nine-year-old girl from New York City taking the bouldering world by storm, and her name is Ashima Shiraishi. Guided by her coach and former bouldering star Obe Carrion, this tiny master is crushing competitions and raising the bar for her peers. A trip to the bouldering mecca of Hueco Tanks provides a glimpse of the past for Obe and the start of amazing new adventures for Ashima.

Night 2 (19th June)

SEASONS: FALL

Deep canyons with steep, spring-fed creeks provide Kate Wagner with a soul-session in this paddling paradise.

THIS IS MY WINTER

Get a glimpse behind the scenes of a season with big mountain legend Xavier de le Rue. Dealing with dangers, joys, and the ups and downs of a winter spent skimming his board over steep and gnarly lines, it's all in a day's work for one of the world's finest snowboarders.

THE TRAIL COLLECTOR

People collect all kinds of things: stamps, coins, art. This is a collection of trails.

NARSICAME

Everything you ever wanted to know about 'Strap Induced Digitally Compressed Strapped Syndrome.'

COLD

Grand Prize, Best Film on Climbing. Experience Gasherbrum II in the middle of a deep, dark winter as seen from the raw, honest perspective of alpinist Cory Richard's camera. This film deftly captures the interwoven roles of pain, fear, and doubt — and reveals a harrowing descent that amplifies their isolation and exposure.

BLUE OBSESSION

The beautiful and ever-changing icefalls of Alaskan glaciers provide a stunning setting for some ice climbing adventures

TOWERS OF THE ENNEDI

The Ennedi Desert of Chad is a hot, sand-scoured, and unfriendly place. Veteran climber Mark Synnott brings young climbing stars Alex Honnold and James Pearson to the Ennedi to explore its untouched landscapes

THE FREEDOM CHAIR

Best Film on Mountain Sports. Josh Dueck was an aspiring skier and coach until a ski accident in 2004 changed his life forever. Despite his comeback and success in the world of competitive sit-skiing, he wasn't content.

REEL ROCK: RACE FOR THE NOSE

Welcome to the wildest competition known to man - the speed record on the Nose route of El Capitan. We follow Dean Potter and Sean Leary on their attempt to break this legendary record on the classic route that has been the scene of epic rivalries, brutal accidents, and remains to this day a hotly contested prize.

Lendenfeld Peak (3194m) and Mt Haast (3114m)

Kevin Patterson and Tim Luszczak

Fresh from our trip up Douglas Peak the day before, we set our sights on two more alpine greats – Lendenfeld and Haast. Lendenfeld can best be described as the gateway to the North Ridge of Mt Tasman when climbed from Pioneer Hut. Sadly, with glacial recession, and the resultant formation of a dangerous ice cliff just past Engineer Col, this route is now the domain of the reckless. Unlike the Gunbarrels above the top of the Linda Glacier which are distant enough that they can be traversed beneath with relative safety using speed and an elevated start point, no such option exists for Tasman. The drop point is less than 100 metres above, on a 55 degree slope, and a slow two-tooled horizontal traverse is required.

So on 25 December 2011 we started at 1am to climb Lendenfeld and Haast. Conditions were stunning, the sky inky black and clear with untold stars shining down. By 5am we were at Marcel Col. This was much easier to get to than the previous col (Douglas-Glacier) with a well-worn trail in place. We then rapidly ascended Lendenfeld with just using one walking tool to the summit with the sunrise at 6.30am. Lendenfeld is notorious for hard ice, however on this occasion conditions were so primo you could

have fallen up it.

We did this trip with Stu and Ross (two Americans) who went on to attempt Tasman. However they returned shortly with a story to tell of nearly getting cleaned out by ice falling off those new ice cliffs just before Syme Ridge. An ascent from Plateau Hut via Syme Ridge is now recognised as the best way up Mt Tasman.

Returning to Marcel Col, we then picked our way up through the snow and rock bands to the final 20 metre step up to the summit ridge. The rope came out and I lead us through this steep snow and rock step in rapidly softening conditions summing at 8.30am. "Do you realised you just climbed your age" Tim said as he joined me. Oh yeah, I've just done my 48th peak in the 100 great peaks list – what a Christmas pressie. "48 'n still crushin!" yelled out Ross from below. Okay, so I only need to climb one of these a year now to stay 'ahead of the curve' right?

Downclimbing was rapid, though the trip across the Fox neve was not! Softening of the snow cover saw an exhausted party collapse for a big afternoon chillout at the hut from 1pm – 12 hours all up.



AVALANCHE EDUCATION

Visit: www.mountainsafety.org.nz

Avalanche Courses 2012

Avalanche Awareness for Skiers and Snowboarders

	Evening lecture	Field day
Dates:	29 June	30 June
	13 July	14 July
	27 July	28 July
	31 Aug	1 Sept
	21 Sept	22 Sept

Cost: \$150*

Location: Queenstown Police Station & Remarkables Ski Area

Avalanche Awareness for Trampers and Climbers

	Evening lecture	Field day
Dates:	29 June	30 June
	28 July	29 July
	21 Sept	22 Sept

Cost: \$150*

Location: Queenstown Police Station & Remarkables Ski Area

Backcountry Awareness

Dates:	27 July	28 July - 31 July
	14 Sept	15 Sept - 18 Sept

Cost: \$650*

Location: Queenstown Police Station & Remarkables Ski Area

**If you are not a pass holder at The Remarkables Ski Area we have negotiated a special lift pass day rate of \$20. Participants also require a transceiver, shovel and probe. We have this equipment to hire at a cost of \$5 each.*

Contact: Mountain Safety Council Wakatipu

E: wakatipu@mountainsafety.org.nz

T: 021 2018 961



OUTDOOR SAFETY
NEW ZEALAND MOUNTAIN
SAFETY COUNCIL



DISCOVER
MORE, SAFELY ▲

Upcoming Club Trips

Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

And remember we love to hear about your trips – send stories to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz

6–8 July: North Island Ice Climbing Meet – Tukino Lodge (Mt. Ruapehu)

Trip organiser: Adam Power

This is a six day ice/mixed climbing trip to Mt. Ruapehu. The plan is to spend three nights at Ruapehu Hut and three more nights at Tukino Lodge to join the North Island Ice Climbing Meet. Participants are welcome for part of or the whole trip. Climbers should have ice and or mixed experience or must have robust alpine experience and be eager to learn these techniques. Possible routes and areas include: Barium Enema Face, Cathedral Rocks, East Buttress of Girdlestone, Chiming Bells and many more.

For information and sign up contact Adam at adamipower@yahoo.com or 021 0269 8151



Cathedral Rocks (photo by Adam Power)

August 2012: Mt. Murchison (Arthur's Pass)

Trip organiser: Mark Hooker.

28–30 September: North Island Ski Touring Meet – Tukino Lodge (Mt. Ruapehu)

Trip organiser: Magnus Hammarsal at hammarsal@gmail.com (Auckland Section).

Notices

Hello all,

Winter is approaching, which means different things to different members of NZAC.

Some are preparing for Section Snowcraft Courses.

Some are busy maintaining and repairing huts after a busy summer season.

Some are scrambling to secure tickets to the Banff Mountain Film Festival.

Some are checking the webcams for their local skifield.

Some are sharpening their tools for some ice climbing.

Some are hoping that cold weather friction will help them send a boulder project.

Some are doing endless squats and cardio-vascular work, in preparation for ski-touring.

Some are organising or going on section trips.

Some are submitting photos to the annual NZAC Photographic Competition.

Some are enjoying a warm evening indoors, amongst like-minded company, at a section talk.

Whatever winter means to you as a climber or alpinist, I hope you make the most of it. Here is a round-up of NZAC news.

Ruapehu Hut is open for the winter!

Thanks to some last-minute begging and some very kind decision making by some DOC authorities, we have been allowed to keep Ruapehu Hut open for the winter, despite not being compliant with the waste water regulations. So it is available to all club members this winter. Enjoy it for what it is, a fantastic place to base yourself for a variety of alpine activities. The Club Committee Meeting has allocated \$45,000 to getting the hut compliant this summer, by far the biggest capital expenditure project for the club this year. This project will inevitably rely on some volunteer labour, so make yourself known if you are keen to help out.

Remarkables Ice and Mixed Festival

The Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival in Queenstown is shaping up to host the biggest concentration of climbing talent in New Zealand, ever. Thirty unclimbed mixed routes will be available to a maximum of 60 participants to climb (there are 14 places left). There will be prizes for the most difficult new route completed during the festival (a male and a female team award), the most difficult repeated route (clean redpoint or onsight, male and female awards) and winter climb of the season. Concurrently, 34 participants (no places left) new to the sport will receive instruction from some of the best climbers in the country. Numerous slideshows, workshops, guest speakers and social activities are also planned for the three days and four nights. The festival will culminate with every participant completing a Grand Traverse of the Remarkables (with prizes for the fastest) and the Banff Mountain Film Festival. Proceeds from the vent will be donated to the NZAC Expedition Fund. <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/>

National Indoor Bouldering Series

The series started off with a bang last Saturday night at The Rxxx in Christchurch. For details on the next three comps of the series go to: nbs.org.nz

- 23 June, Hangdog, Wellington
- 28 July, Extreme Edge, Hamilton
- 1 September, Extreme Edge, Panmure

Photocamp open for entries

Dig out that camera and explore your creative side! Entries are now being accepted for the 2012 NZAC Photographic Competition. To make an online entry, log on to alpineclub.org.nz and go to: alpineclub.org.nz/node/add/image This year we hope to surpass 1000 entries, so get your photos in before the cut-off date of 21 June.

National Climbing Camp

The Otago Section has generously offered to host the next National Climbing Camp in January, 2013. While it is only the formative stages of planning, it is envisaged that it will held in the Makarora area, which will give access to the numerous climbing opportunities in the Young and Wilkin Valleys, the Mount Brewster area and even rock climbing at Wanaka. Participants in previous National Climbing Camps have given very positive feedback and the Otago Section has an enviable reputation as good hosts of the National Climbing Camp. Watch this space for more details as they emerge.

Refresher course for lapsed mountaineers

Have you been a climber in years past, but for one reason or another let your skills slip? This course is your chance to up-skill with others in a similar situation. We envisage a friendly, non-competitive get-together of enthusiastic climbers keen to pick up some modern techniques and relearn the skills they have lost. The course will run from 24-27 August on Mt Ruapehu. For further details got to: www.alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine

Mountain Skills for Youth

Due to demand we have brought another instructor on board for this course, which is for 16 – 18 year olds keen to learn alpine skills This has made two extra places available. For further information and an application form go to: www.alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine

Extra course places now available

The same applies to the Progression to Leading on Ice and Intro to Backcountry Skiing courses. By bringing in extra guides there are now limited extra places available on these courses, which were previously full. www.alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine

Unwin Arts Workshops

Due to the outrageous success of the Unwin Painting and Photography workshops in April, a second workshop will run at the end of the year. (2-5 November). Tutors will be Colin Monteath (photography) and Jane Zusters (painting). Check out The Climber, issue 80 to see the results of the April workshop, and register your interest with Pat at: pat@alpineclub.org.nz

National Summer Instruction Programme

Applications for the National Instruction Programme will open on 5 June. The programme includes the following courses: High Alpine Skills, Mountain Skills for Women, Advanced High Alpine Skills and Introduction to Multi-pitch Alpine Rock. For information go to: www.alpineclub.org.nz/national-instruction-courses/alpine

Club Committee Meeting, 19/20 May

The Club Committee Meeting (CCM) is NZAC's highest decision making body. It is comprised of the chairpersons of every section and is presided over by the club president, currently Stu Gray. The CCM meets every six months to take stock of progress on delivering our Strategic Plan, debate the issues of the day and make plans. The key points of discussions and approval were:

- Expenditure of \$45,000 was approved to install a new toilet at Ruapehu Hut, to ensure it is compliant with DOC requirements regarding wastewater.
- The reprinting of several guidebooks including Backcountry Skiing, Arthur's Pass, Aoraki/Mount Cook and Moirs North. As well as the publication of a North Island Rock Deluxe and a Wanaka Rock Climbing guidebook.
- The upgrading of the climbnz.org.nz website and the development and launch of climber.co.nz
- The high cost of sewerage removal at high huts such as Pioneer and Centennial.
- The increasing trend towards online sales of everything from membership fees, to Banff tickets to guidebooks.
- The possible establishment of a Heritage sub-committee to oversee the growing book collections held at section and national level, as well as investigate the digitisation of archived NZAJs.
- Liability Insurance for guides instructing on NZAC courses.
- The Governance Review

[Climbnz.org.nz](http://climbnz.org.nz)

The success of the climbnz website is starting to snowball. With over 8000 routes inputted, it is a close to comprehensive NZ route database. The club has committed to an upgrade in the next few months, aimed at improving the look and feel of the site and making it more user-friendly. Members are encouraged to take ownership of the site, sign up and input new routes or edit existing information on their local crags or favourite alpine areas. It is a world class resource and something members should be proud of.

Governance Review

The Club is reviewing its Governance to ensure the appropriate checks and balances are in place and we have the right separation of club governance from our regular operational management. With annual revenue of \$1 million, full time professional staff and involvement across a wide range of activities - accommodation, instruction, publishing, Banff, and much more - we need to be sure our decision making processes are clear.

The Club Committee has agreed in principle to changes that make clear the Club Committee, which meets twice yearly and is largely Section representatives, is responsible for governance, strategy, and protecting the values of the Club. A revamped Executive Committee, renamed the Executive Board and still reporting to the Club Committee as now, would be responsible for the financial management of the Club. This Executive Board would meet four times a year and would be a mix of ex-officio members (eg the President and Hon. Treasurer) and appointed club members. This will enable the Club to call on the skills of a broader range of Club members.

The next stage in the Review is a revised version to be circulated to Section Reps, with the goal being approval of the required rule changes at the Club AGM later this year.

So, a lot of things happening and plenty for us to get our teeth stuck into. Sign up, click the links and get involved. A huge thanks to all the members who make these things happen!

Sam Newton
General Manager - NZAC

General Manager – New Zealand Alpine Club
M: 027 723 9380 | P: (03) 377 7595 | F: (03) 377 7594
sam@alpineclub.org.nz

NZ Backcountry Skiing guidebook is back...

A reprint has been completed of the NZ Backcountry Skiing guidebook. We are coupling up with Avalanche Awareness for a winter special. \$40 the pair for members and \$60 for non-members + p&p. Buy online here: <http://alpineclub.org.nz/product/avalanche-awareness-and-nz-backcountry-skiing-member>

The Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival

The Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival in Queenstown is shaping up to be the biggest concentration of climbing talent in New Zealand, ever. 30 unclimbed mixed routes, available to a maximum of 60 participants (20 places left). Prizes for Hardest New Route of the Festival (male and female team award), Hardest Repeated Route (clean redpoint or onsight male and female award) and Winter Climb of the season.

Concurrently, 30 participants (10 places left) new to the sport will receive instruction from some of the best climbers in the game.

Numerous slideshows, workshops, guest speakers and social activities are also spread over the three days/ four nights. Culminating in every participant completing a Grand Traverse of the Remarkables - prizes for the fastest - and the Banff Mountain Film Festival. Unreal event. Be part of history and attend the inaugural Remarkables Ice & Mixed Festival. Thanks to sponsorship and volunteer effort, it is a bargain at \$50!!

Detail on registration questions can be found here: <http://www.iceandmixedfestival.co.nz/> then contact Narina@alpineclub.org.nz to place your registration.

Alpine instruction

For those who were interested in completing the 2012 Wellington section NZAC alpine instruction course, the opportunity is still there through the Tararua Tramping Club. Most of the TTC instructors are NZAC members and the TTC course closely follows the syllabus of NZAC course but also includes a snow caving weekend and Avalanche Awareness weekend. Total course cost is \$1,000.00 which can be paid in instalments. Participants will be required to join the TTC. Full details can be found on www.ttc.org.nz or by contacting course convenor Paul Maxim on 389 6945 / 027 4470 459 / p.maxim@xtra.co.nz

Tukino Alpine Sports Club

The latest issue of the Tukino Alpine Sports Club's newsletter can be downloaded from <http://tukinoalpinesportsclub.org.nz/wp-content/uploads/2012/05/Newletter-Autumn-2012-No-2-New.pdf>



Winter Skills and Risk Management Training Courses Available from OPC

The Outdoor Pursuits Centre (OPC) is offering a range of Winter Skills Courses and a Risk Management Training Course from late June through to mid-August 2012. Courses include Introductory and Intermediate Mountain Skills - each 5 days duration from 6 - 10 August, and Avalanche Awareness - Stage One - 7 days duration from 6 - 12 August. Costs include accommodation, meals and use of some equipment/gear. The Risk Management Course runs from 25 - 29 June and the cost includes meals and accommodation. For further information on how to enroll, or to make a booking, visit <http://www.opc.org.nz> or e-mail: reception@opc.org.nz.

Wellington Section 2011/12 contacts list

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	vacant	chairperson	
Vice Chair	Hinrich Schaefer	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h), or 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	vacant		
Patron	John Nankervis		
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
	Nina Sawicki	NS	
	Dan Pringle	DP	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	vacant	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction Coordinator	vacant		
Instruction - AIC	Fraser Crichton		
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Joke Meerkens	library	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill Overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Jeremy Tries	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
03 3777 595	National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz



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\$1000 worth of new holds in Jan/Feb 2012

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* to be precise, this is just an average but we do aim for new routes every single week.



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www.hangdog.co.nz

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Wellington

